

Northwind Technologies - Performance Review Process

1. Review Cycle

Northwind runs two formal review cycles per year: a mid-year review in July and an annual review in January. Compensation changes are decided only in the annual cycle and take effect from 1 April.

2. Eligibility

Employees who joined on or before 30 September are eligible for the January annual review. Those who joined later receive their first formal review in the following July cycle, though probation reviews still apply.

3. Self Assessment

The cycle opens with a self assessment, which must be submitted within 10 business days. Employees are asked to list their three most significant contributions, evidence of impact, and two areas they want to develop.

4. Peer Feedback

Each employee nominates three to five peers, and the manager may add up to two more. Peer feedback is shared with the employee in summarised form and is never attributed to a named individual.

5. Rating Scale

Ratings are on a five point scale: 1 Needs Improvement, 2 Developing, 3 Meets Expectations, 4 Exceeds Expectations, 5 Outstanding. Northwind does not operate a forced distribution or a quota for any rating.

6. Calibration

Before ratings are released, department heads meet to calibrate them so that a rating of 4 means the same thing across teams. Calibration may change a proposed rating, and the manager must explain any change to the employee.

7. Promotions

Promotion nominations are raised by the reporting manager during the annual cycle and require a rating of 4 or 5 in the two most recent cycles. Promotion decisions are made by a panel of at least three people, one of whom must be from outside the nominee's department.

8. Disagreeing With a Review

An employee who disagrees with their rating may request a review by the Head of People within 10 business days of receiving it. The outcome of that review is final for the cycle.